

APER™ Diagnostic: Actionable Product Economic Review

A Forensic Audit of Engineering Capital Efficiency

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01. The Thesis: Product Management is Capital Allocation

Most organizations treat engineering bandwidth as "Infinite Inventory." It is not. It is your most expensive capital asset. The APER Diagnostic is not an "Agile Health Check." It is a solvency audit. We calculate the "Cost of Goods Sold" (COGS) for every feature in your backlog to determine if your product organization is generating leverage or consuming cash.

Engineering as Capital

Your most expensive asset requires rigorous financial discipline

COGS Analysis

Every feature has a calculable cost that must justify its existence

Solvency Audit

Determining if you're generating leverage or consuming cash

02. The Core Metric: Revenue Per Employee (RPE)

The ultimate measure of a Product Team is not velocity; it is **RPE Leverage**.

The Trap:

As you hire more engineers, RPE often declines (The "Bloat Curve").

The Goal:

The APER audit identifies the "Break-Even Point" where the marginal cost of the next engineer exceeds the marginal revenue they generate.



03. The Audit Mechanism: Identifying "Zombie Code"

We scan the codebase and product analytics to identify three categories of waste:



Zombie Features:

High maintenance cost, near-zero adoption. (Immediate Kill).



Vanity Projects:

Features built for "Strategic alignment" with no path to monetization. (CapEx Risk).



The "Maybe" Queue:

Backlog items that have been sitting for >90 days. (Intellectual Debt).

04. The Output: The Solvency Report

At the end of the 14-day diagnostic, you receive:



The Red List:

A list of features to kill immediately to recover 20% of engineering capacity.



The Reallocation Map:

Moving capital from "Run the Business" (Maintenance) to "Change the Business" (Growth).



The RPE Forecast:

A projection of solvency based on current hiring plans.

05. Engagement Model



Duration:

14 Days.



Access Required:

Read-only access to Jira, GitHub,
and Stripe/Revenue data.



Deliverable:

Executive Board Briefing & PDF
Audit.